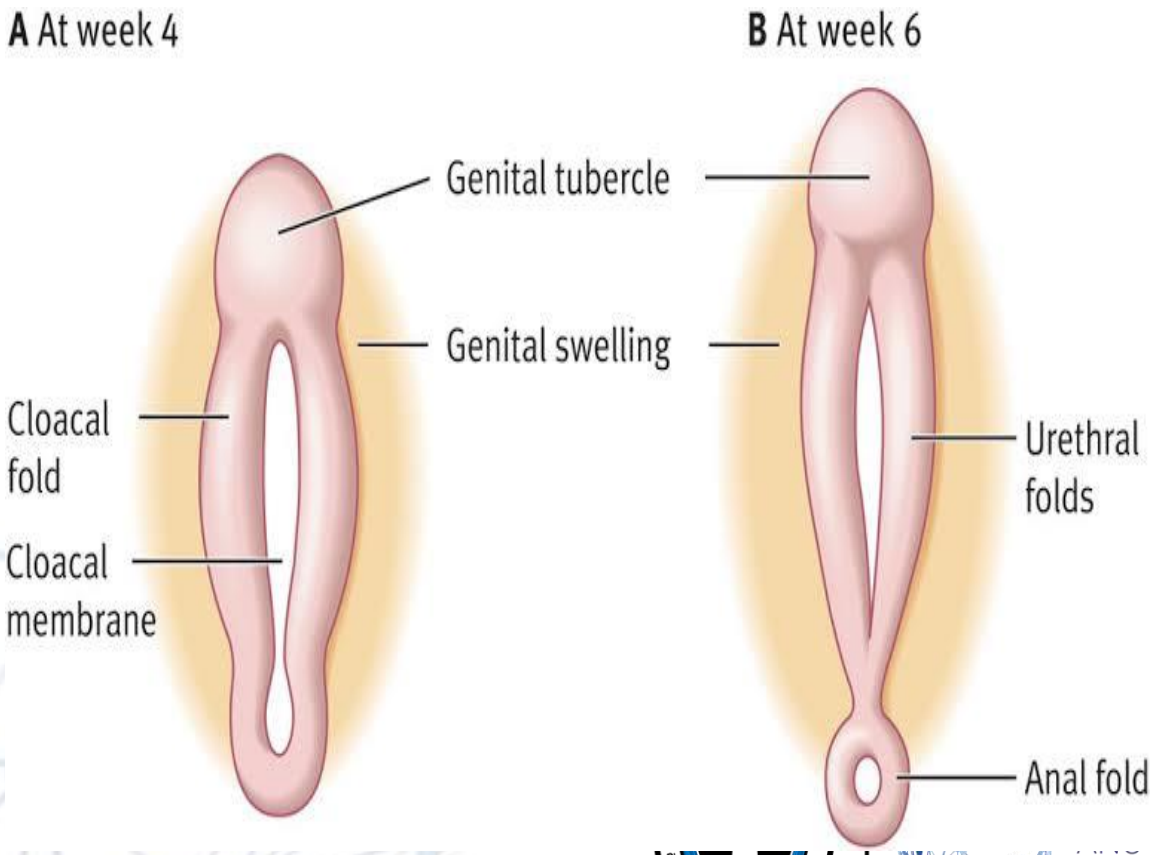
Development of the external genitalia

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Development of the external genitalia

Indifferent Stage

- Mesenchyme cells around the cloacal membrane proliferate to form cloacal folds. The cranial ends of the folds unite to form the genital tubercle.
- Caudally, the anterior parts of the folds will form the urethral folds while most posteriorly they will form the anal fold.
- At the same time, another pair of elevations, the genital swellings, becomes visible on each side of the urethral folds.

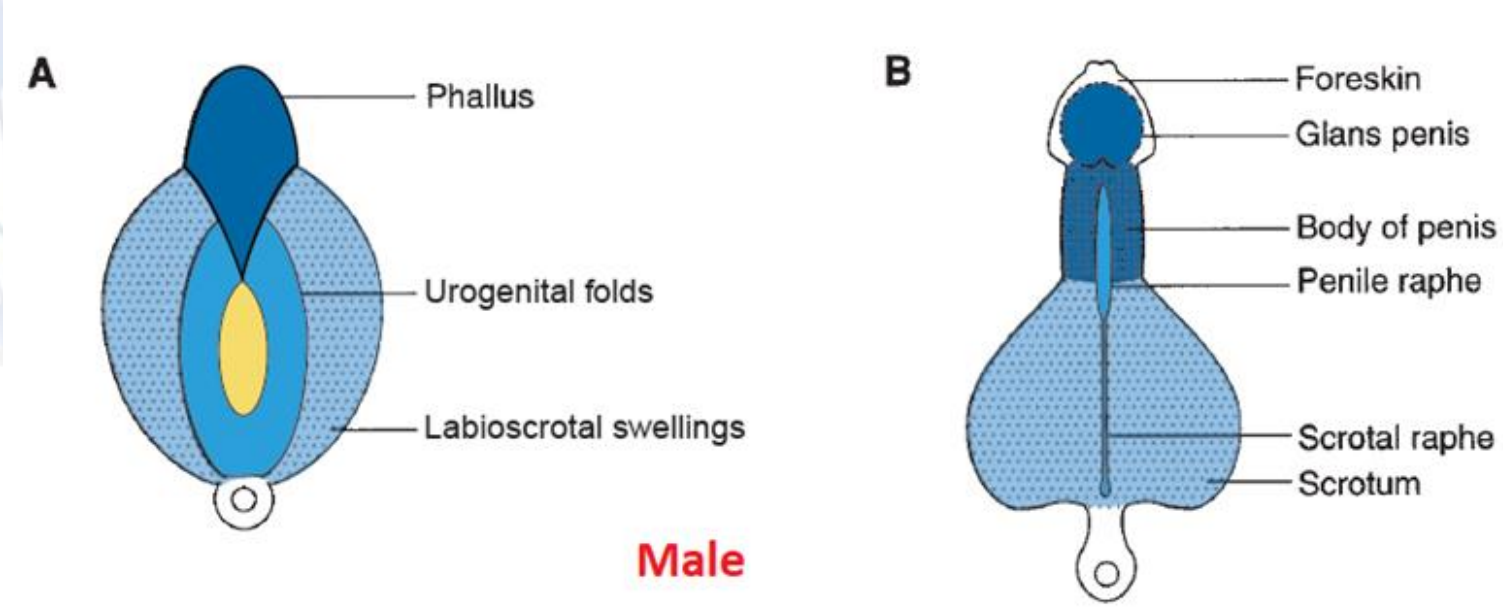


External genitalia in male:

There is rapid elongation of the genital tubercle which is now called the phallus (penis).

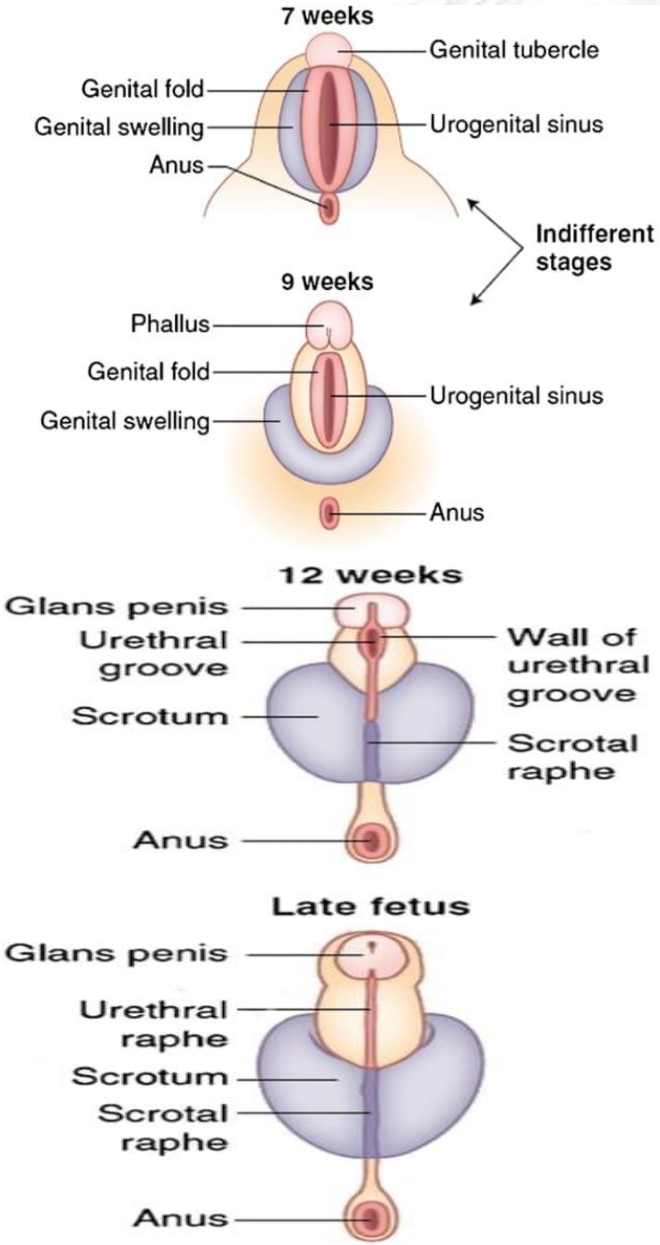
The urethral folds elongate and form the urethral grove. The urethral folds meet forming the penile urethra.

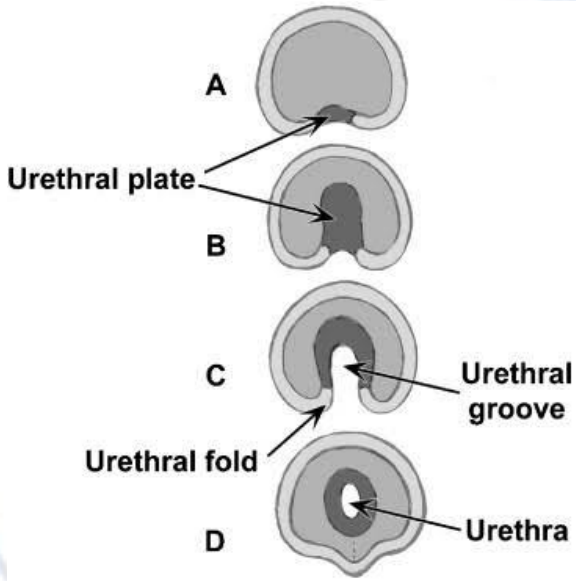
The genital swellings will form the scrotum.

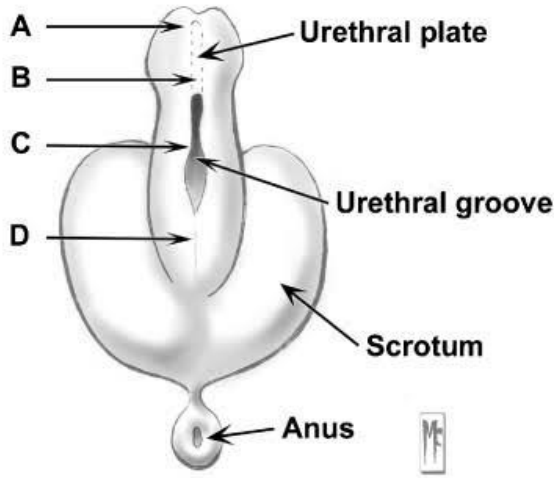


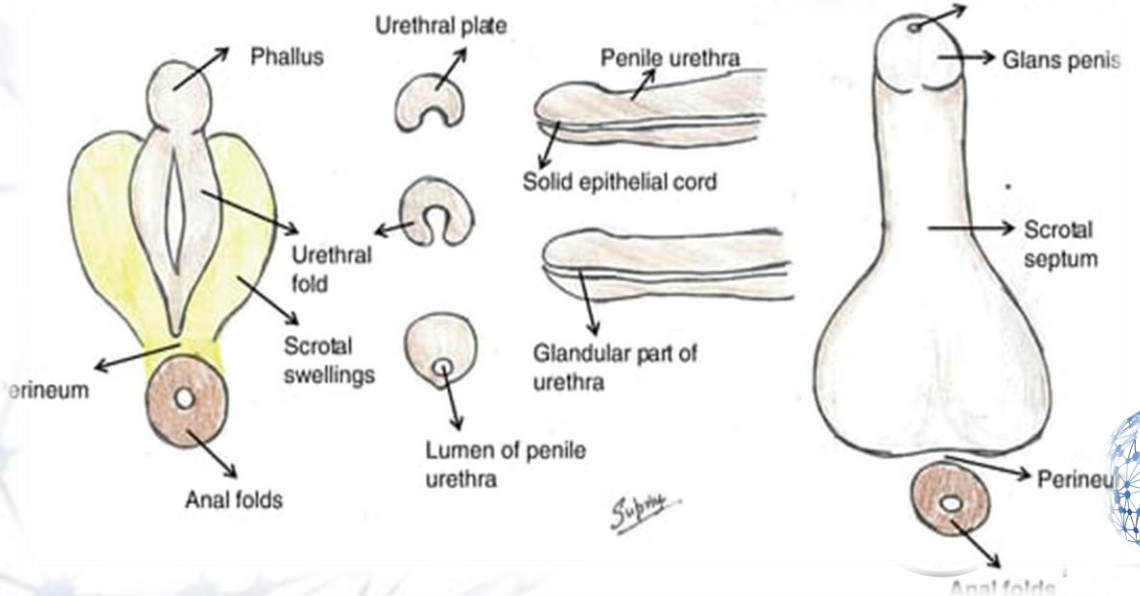
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External genitalia in male:





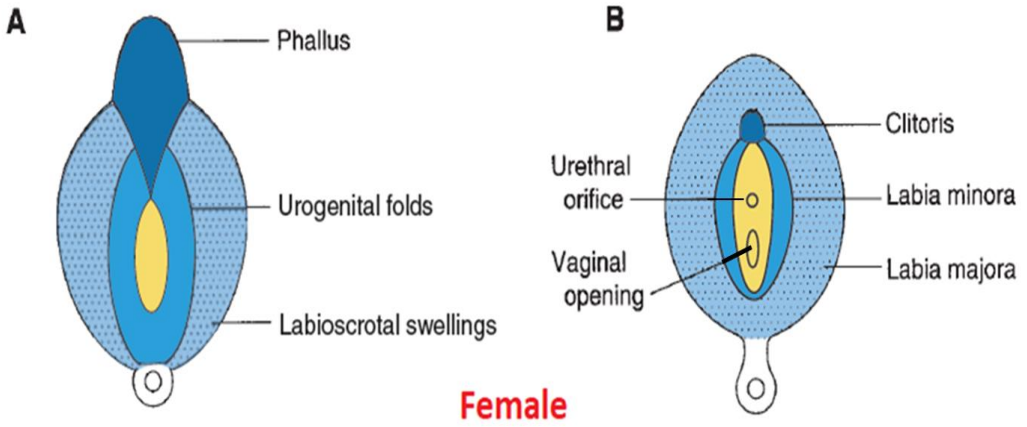


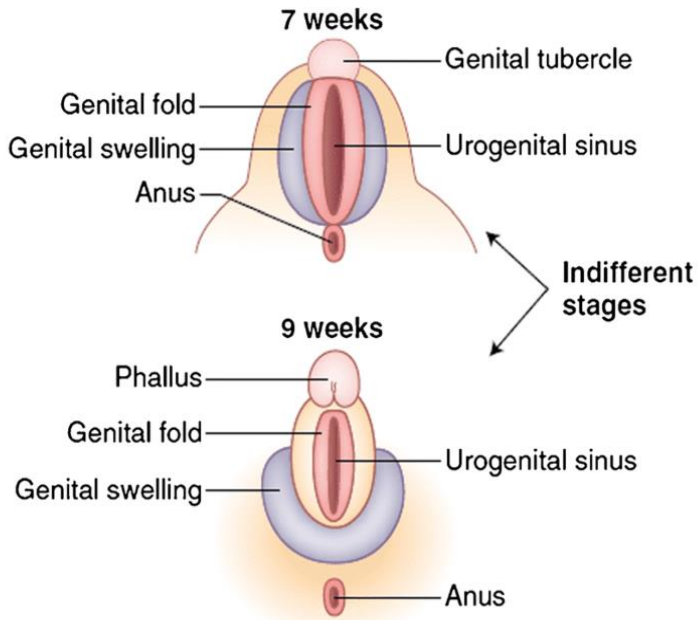


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External genitalia in female:

- The genital tubercle elongates only slightly and forms the clitoris.
- Urethral folds do not fuse, as in the male, but develop into the labia minora.
- Genital swellings enlarge and form the labia majora





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